

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 4 3

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ K 8 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A 8 5 4



♠ 10 5

♥ J 10 4 2

♦ 9 6 5 4 3

♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6

♥ A Q 9

♦ A 10 7

♣ K Q 7 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

6NT

2NT

All Pass

6NT by South

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the contract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid 4-card Major in either hand.

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ 10 2

♠ A 2

♥ A 9 7

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A K Q 7 6



♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ 10 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ J 10

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q J 9 8 7

♣ J 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♦
Pass	6 ♦		
All Pass			
6 ♦ by South			

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6 ♦

Lead the ♠ 4.

Against a notrump slam it is best to make a passive lead so you don't give declarer an undeserved winner.

Against a suit slam the situation is very different. Against strong dummy bidding like this you are pretty sure that if you don't establish a winner early declarer will find something in dummy to discard losers on. In this hand it is dummy's ♣ suit.

Your most promising suit is ♠s. Obviously partner has a very weak hand, but if he has the ♠Q you can set up your ♠K before your King of trumps is dislodged.

Without a ♠ lead declarer will have smooth sailing.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8
♥ Q 10 5 4 2
♦ 7 3
♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5
♥ J 7
♦ K Q 8
♣ K J 9 8 2



♠ K 6 2
♥ K 6 3
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3
♥ A 9 8
♦ A J 10 6
♣ Q 10 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥4.

This is a close call. The top of your ♠ honor sequence is very tempting, but even when you find partner with the ♠K you can still only establish three ♠ winners to go with your ♣A. Unfortunately, that's not enough to defeat the contract.

Leading a ♥ from your 5-card suit is riskier, but it has the potential of setting up an additional winner. In this hand, as you see, the ♥ lead gets you 4 ♥ winners to go with your ♣A.